

Winter 2026/27 LINK-S and the list

A source-backed brief for Shen Ruililin on every winter row of the IAO
Recognised Programmes list, plus LINK-S — scored for experience, meaning,
and memory, without inventing a Lillehammer that January cannot buy.

Enrol in LINK-S before 4 September 2026, 23:59, unless you have already chosen first-ness over family-and-credits.
Tübingen and Lille are the NEWDAY cousins; their dates lose. Do not spend SSE on three weeks. Confirm HKUWW
criterion 3 in writing.

For: Shen Ruililin · BAsC Global Health and Development ·
HKU

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Window 24 Dec 2026 – 17 Jan 2027 · LINK Round 2 closes
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0. How to read this

IAO's Recognised Programmes page is a **reference list of programmes HKU students have previously attended**, last updated **21 May 2026**. It is not an exchange catalogue and not a promise of credit. Short-term programmes are, unless otherwise noted, **not available on an exchange basis**: you apply to the host and you pay the host.

LINK is not on that list. LINK is an **HKU 12-credit Horizons course** with a three-week immersion. Comparing LINK-S to Yonsei is comparing a home-course field component to a host winter school. Different products. The question is which *life* you want in that gap, not which logo looks busier on a CV.

How numbers are labelled

- **Published / dated**: copied from an official page with access date 22 Aug 2026 unless noted.
- **Arithmetic**: addition of published subsidy rows. Not a quote.
- **UNVERIFIED**: not on an official page we fetched, internally inconsistent, or the official page is silent / stale.
- **Proxy**: last published edition used as *shape* for an unpublished 2027 cycle. Never treat a proxy as a booking.

Stars (★) are **operator scores** on five axes: experience, meaning, memory, calendar-fit, NEWDAY-likeness. They are not host ratings. A 2★ memory in a city you have never seen can still beat a 4★ course in a city you already know, depending on what you are actually trying to maximise.

Subagents used (2026-08-22): parallel crawls of Europe, Korea/Japan, Americas/China/Oceania, and NEWDAY/city texture, plus direct fetches of official HTML. This document is the synthesis. Host sites change without notice. Re-read anything past `reverifyAfter` in `.tmp/winter-primer/claims.jsonl`.

1. Three winters

There are winters you inherit and winters you buy.

The inherited one is a kitchen in Shanghai in late December. The extractor fan. The wet cold that never quite becomes snow. A grandparent who will not say how long the visit is allowed to last. You already know this city in its bones. Going back is not discovery. It is maintenance of a relationship that does not care about your transcript.

The bought one, last summer, was a garden in Lillehammer where, if the weather permitted, you sat talking around a campfire in light that refused to die. Nansen priced that at **11,000 NOK** for a double room, food and lodging included, **nine days**, travel extra. You loved it. That is a data point, not a personality quiz. It says you want a small room, a real argument, woods, and people from the other side of a map who are not performing cosmopolitanism.

The third winter is the one IAO listed: SKY campuses that turn December into a credit mill; European January programmes that begin after your second semester has already started; a Chilean classical-liberal seminar that would send you to the Andes six months before Laidlaw already sends you toward the Andes; a Fudan classroom three metro stops from the grandparents you could have been eating with instead.

You asked for experience, meaning, and memory. Those are not the same currency.

- **Experience** is what the days are *made of*: lectures, projects, walking, cold, other people.
- **Meaning** is whether the days metabolise into a thesis you can still use in April.
- **Memory** is what will still be specific in ten years: a smell, a dark street, a person, a room.

NEWDAY scored high on all three because the form did the work: residential, dialogic, small, in a landscape that was itself an argument. Winter 2026/27 cannot repurchase that form. Nansen has **no winter equivalent**. NEWDAY 2027 is **unpublished**. The honest move is to stop shopping for Lillehammer in January and choose among the winters that actually exist.

2. Corrections (do not twin)

1. **NEWDAY cannot be bought in winter.** Official 2026 course: **29 Jul – 6 Aug 2026**, 9 days, Nansen Academy, Lillehammer. Double **11,000 NOK** / single **15,000 NOK**, programme + excursions + food + lodging; travel extra. Organisers named on the live page: Chunrong Liu, **Daniel Bell (University of Hong Kong)**, Geir Helgesen, Unn Irene Aasdalen. Admissions for 2026 ran from 20 January 2026 until full. The 2027 page does not exist. The other Nansen courses are art, writing, music, an Olympic academy — not East–West dialogue. Do not wait for a winter NEWDAY.
2. **LINK is LINK-S and LINK-V, one course, two immersions.** Official name: Leadership and Innovation Network for Knowledge. LINK-S: lectures **Sept–Dec 2026 + Shanghai 27 Dec 2026 – 16 Jan 2027**. LINK-V: lectures **Jan–Apr 2027 + Ho Chi Minh City 1–20 June 2027**. LINK-V collides with Laidlaw LiA summer 2027. Do not treat “LINK” as a free-floating brand you can slide to June without costing the summer.
3. **The Recognized list is not an offer.** IAO: “solely intended as a reference.” Email goabroad@hku.hk if you want something off-list reviewed. Being on the list helps short-term scholarship *registration*; it does not waive host tuition.
4. **Most European winter schools miss your window.** Lille **6–23 Jan 2027**, Tübingen **4–29 Jan 2027**, Tallinn **11–29 Jan 2027**, univie **29 Jan – 12 Feb 2027**, TU Berlin on-campus **5–29 Jan 2027**, KEDGE 2027 unpublished (2026 ran **12–23 Jan**). The European programmes that *feel* like NEWDAY cousins are the ones whose dates lose.
5. **Fudan winter is not a substitute for LINK-S.** Fudan International Winter Session: **21 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027**, CNY **400** application + **18,000** tuition (**16,200** early bird), self-housing, English classroom China-economy/AI/society. LINK-S is a 12-credit HKU project-execution course with a published subsidy. Different genre. LINK wins on dates, credits, and family. Fudan wins only if you specifically want a Fudan transcript and are willing to miss HKU exams / Fudan registration.

6. **Seoul in December is not Lillehammer.** Yonsei, Korea University, and Hanyang are large, professional winter campuses: orientation videos, commencement ceremonies, club activities, tuition in the 1.6–1.9 million KRW band. They can be excellent. They are a different *species*.
7. **Do not spend SSE on a three-week trip.** SSE is **once per undergraduate, irrespective of amount**. A later full-year North American exchange sits in a different duration band. Trading the once-in-a-degree SSE for a 14–28 day ceiling is bad physics even before anyone looks at a bank account. (Whether you are means-tested at all is **UNVERIFIED** — this brief does not touch private finance.)
8. **Tung & Ngai’s HK\$80,000 shared cap is not assumed to pay LINK.** Nothing published says a Horizons 3-week course draws on that pot. Whether LINK-S satisfies the compulsory Mainland exchange is **UNVERIFIED** — only AASO / the Foundation can answer. Do not bet a Chicago year on a winter school without that email.
9. **Short-term IAO scholarships are once-shaped.** Registry merit awards: each student is eligible for a total equal to the **largest single award** in the undergraduate career; a second award can claw back the first. Scale last updated **9 Sep 2025**. Winter 2026/27 registration deadlines are **not yet posted** (the page still shows Winter 2025-26).
10. **You already have a Berlin memory.** World Health Summit 2025. HUWISU Term 1 (**4–15 Jan 2027**) is a calendar-fit European classroom, and January Berlin is not October Berlin. It is still a return, not a first.
11. **LiA already spends the Americas.** TFAS Santiago is a real programme with a real hotel and a real ideology. It is also southern summer in a hemisphere Laidlaw is already taking you to in 2027, and it overruns Sem 2 by six days.
12. **Host grades on a Recognized winter school are not HKU GPA.** Credit transfer is a separate SPH conversation. LINK is pass/fail and **GPA-exempt by published rule**. Do not take a Yonsei letter grade to “protect” a 4.09; the 4.09 is not at risk from LINK.

3. The window

HKU Academic Calendar 2026-27 (undergraduate / taught postgraduate):

BLOCK	DATES
Sem 1 last teaching	30 Nov 2026
Revision	1–5 Dec 2026
Assessment	7–23 Dec 2026
Sem 1 ends	23 Dec 2026
Break	24 Dec 2026 – 17 Jan 2027
Sem 2 teaching starts	18 Jan 2027

Traveler-stated winter window: **24 Dec 2026 – 17 Jan 2027**, earlier only if assessments have ended. This brief treats 24 Dec as the earliest wheels-up unless you later confirm an earlier last paper.

Fits inside the gap (complete, or complete enough to argue):

PROGRAMME	PUBLISHED DATES	CATCH
LINK-S	27 Dec 2026 – 16 Jan 2027	Native fit. Lectures already ran Sept–Dec.
Hanyang Session A	26 Dec 2026 – 9 Jan 2027	Clean Korea classroom fit. Site update 1 Sep 2026 ; fees on the tuition page still show a 1 Nov 2025 early-bird line — treat money as provisional .
Vilnius Lithuanian language	4–15 Jan 2027	Only fully confirmed <i>small</i> European complete fit. Language-only. Self-housing.
HUWISU Term 1 (selected courses)	4–15 Jan 2027	Berlin classroom. Self-housing. You have been to Berlin. Term 2 (18–29 Jan) misses. German intensive runs to 29 Jan — miss.

PROGRAMME	PUBLISHED DATES	CATCH
Virginia Tech residential	Blacksburg 4–15 Jan 2027 (exams 16 Jan); virtual from 28 Dec 2026	Visiting students are invited (apply by 15 Dec 2026 , US\$25 fee). Housing and immigration for a 3-week HK visitor remain UNVERIFIED — no published I-20 path on the visiting page.
TU Berlin Term 2	Overview: 5–15 Jan 2027 , 3 ECTS. Some course pages still print 5–29 Jan / 6 ECTS	Conditional FIT. Confirm the <i>named course</i> dates in writing. STEM/Industry 5.0, not dialogue.
Yonsei WAY	22 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027	22 Dec is a full academic day. Leave on 24 Dec and you miss two teaching days plus in-person orientation.
KU IWC 3-week	22 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027	Same 22 Dec problem. 4-week runs to 18 Jan — overruns Sem 2.
Hanyang Internship	14 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027	Starts <i>inside</i> assessment period. Only if last paper is early. 8 hours/day.
Fudan winter	21 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027	Registration 19 Dec / orientation 20 Dec sit inside HKU exams.

Everything else is a miss, a proxy, or unpublished.

HKUWW 2027/28: apply **12 Oct – 11 Dec 2026**; **late Dec** and **mid-Jan** interviews *if applicable*; results **5 Feb 2027**. Interviews sit **inside LINK-S**. Video format is **UNVERIFIED**.

4. What NEWDAY actually was

From the live Nansen page (nansensko1en.no/kurset/newday/, fetched 22 Aug 2026), not from memory:

*We offer lectures, discussions, socializing, workshops and excursions.
There will be workshops and dialogue groups, addressing current affairs. In addition, museum visits and walks in the serenity of the surrounding Norwegian nature.
The homes of two Nobel Prize laureates of literature who lived in the vicinity will welcome us: Sigrid Undset's Bjerkebæk and Bjørnstjerne Bjørnson's Aulestad.
If the weather permits, we will sit talking around the campfire in the light summer nights in the garden of Nansen Academy.*

That is the DNA. Small. Residential. Dialogic. Landscape as faculty. East Asia in the same room as the Nordics. Nine days that were allowed to be nine days.

Your own NEWDAY essay (already written) named the thesis: sustain a dialogue rather than win an argument; medical ethics as a grammar when political language fails; Nordic consensus against East Asian pace. Winter shopping that ignores that sentence will produce a correct credit and a wrong month.

NEWDAY-likeness on this list, if the calendar were ignored:

PROGRAMME	LIKENESS	WHY
Tübingen T-IES	High	Human rights / migration / sustainability tracks; hostel or host family; town not metropolis; 8 ECTS; fee includes housing.
Lille Winter	Medium-high	Packaged hotel, field trips, intercultural module, Health & Wellness in the <i>usual</i> offer — 2027 afternoon options are art, teams, maybe sustainability. Hotel is not woods.
Tallinn	Medium	Self-description: "Unique. Small. Challenging." Three weeks, cultural programme. Dates lose.
Vilnius	Medium-low	Small language course, Baltic dark, no dialogue academy. The <i>place</i> does some of the work.
HUWISU Term 1	Medium-low	Serious Berlin seminars (refugees, green cities). Not residential-dialogic. You already have a Berlin plenary.

PROGRAMME	LIKENESS	WHY
LINK-S	Low	Project execution, industry, demo logic. Different genre, honestly.
SKY winter schools	Low	Credit mills with club activities. Can be joyful. Not Nansen.

Winter cannot buy the gold standard. It can buy a cousin **if you move the window**, or a different good **if you keep it**.

5. Verdicts

You asked for verdicts. Here they are, as of 22 Aug 2026.

If the question is “what do I enrol in before 4 September?”

LINK-S.

It is the only option that is an HKU course, twelve credits, pass/fail and GPA-exempt, subsidised at HK\$5,000, dated to the gap, and geographically identical to the grandparents. Round 2 closes **4 Sep 2026, 23:59**. Miss that and winter LINK is gone.

This is not “LINK is like NEWDAY.” It is not. LINK is a leadership-and-innovation field course assessed 55% on execution. You will spend January delivering something with a team in a city you already know. The meaning is: **family + Mainland fieldwork + a transcript line that does not gamble the GPA**. The memory is a specific winter with specific people who will not be here forever. That is a legitimate maximand. It is not the maximand you used in Lillehammer. Hold both facts at once.

If the question is “maximise world-not-seen memory inside the window”

Hanyang Session A (first Korea, Nutrition and Disease Prevention on the tentative academic list, 26 Dec – 9 Jan) **or Vilnius** (first Baltics, 4–15 Jan, €650, language-only) **or HUWISU Term 1** (January Berlin that is not October Berlin: Refugee Protection, Green Cities, 4–15 Jan, €1,050 plus self-housing).

None of these is NEWDAY. Hanyang is the most “programme.” Vilnius is the most “I have never been this far north in January.” Humboldt is the most GHD-adjacent European classroom that actually fits.

If the question is “closest cousin to NEWDAY”

Tübingen T-IES Winter School, 4–29 Jan 2027, fee **€1,950 / €1,800** partner, housing included (youth hostel on the Neckar or host family). Tracks: Europe/Memory/Diversity; **Human Rights and Migration; Sustainability, Biodiversity, and Ethics**. German A1–A2 alongside. This is the winter programme on the list that most nearly shares NEWDAY’s *form*. **The dates lose**. You would miss the first two weeks of Sem 2 unless SPH signs a written exception — which you do not have.

Lille 6–23 Jan 2027 is the packaged-Europe version: hotel, Bruges, Reims, buddy system, €2,500 partner / €2,750 non-partner. Overruns six days. Closer to a well-run summer school in winter clothing than to a campfire.

Do not force either into the 17 Jan wall and then pretend the wall moved.

If the question is “Shanghai classroom instead of LINK”

Do not pick Fudan winter over LINK-S unless you have a specific Fudan-transcript reason. You would pay CNY 16,200–18,000, house yourself, miss Fudan registration if you sit HKU exams, and still be in Shanghai without the 12

HKU credits or the HK\$5,000. LINK is the Shanghai winter that was engineered for HKU's calendar. Fudan is a visiting classroom that happens to be in the same city.

What not to do

- Do not spend the once-per-degree **SSE** on any of these.
- Do not take **LINK-V in June** as a winter substitute; it collides with LiA.
- Do not treat **Yonsei/KU starting 22 Dec** as a clean fit.
- Do not buy **TFAS Santiago** for “the world I haven’t seen” while LiA already spends the Americas, the curriculum is openly classical-liberal, and the dates overrun.
- Do not wait for Sophia / KEDGE / Jinan 2027 pages that are not up.
- Do not confuse **Virginia Tech’s calendar fit** with a ready-to-book visiting pathway.

The adult sentence: enrol in LINK-S this fortnight; keep Hanyang A / Vilnius / HUWISU Term 1 as named alternates if you *choose* to spend the gap on first-ness instead of family-and-credits; keep Tübingen/Lille as summer-shaped cousins for a later January only if Sem 2 can move, which today it cannot.

6. Scoreboard

Operator scores, 22 Aug 2026. Calendar-fit is pass/fail in disguise: a 5★ experience that starts on 18 Jan is still a miss.

PROGRAMME	EXP	MEANING	MEMORY	FIT	NEWDAY	CALL
LINK-S Shanghai	3.5	4.5	4.0	5.0	1.5	Default yes
Hanyang Session A	3.5	2.5	4.0	5.0	1.0	Best SKY fit
Vilnius language	3.0	1.5	4.5	5.0	2.0	Best small-Europe fit
HUWISU Term 1	3.5	3.5	3.0	4.5	2.0	GHD classroom; Berlin return
Yonsei WAY	3.5	2.5	4.0	3.5	1.0	Misses 22 Dec
KU IWC 3-week	3.5	2.0	3.5	3.5	1.0	Same 22 Dec problem
Hanyang Internship	4.0	3.0	3.5	2.0	0.5	Starts 14 Dec
Fudan winter	3.0	2.5	2.0	2.5	1.0	Home city, paid classroom
Virginia Tech	2.5	2.0	3.5	4.5	0.5	Visiting door exists; visa/housing not
TU Berlin Term 2	2.5	2.0	3.0	4.0	1.0	Confirm 5–15 Jan in writing
Tübingen T-IES	4.5	4.5	4.5	1.0	4.5	Best cousin; dates lose
Lille Winter	4.0	3.0	4.0	1.5	3.5	Packaged Europe; overruns
Tallinn	3.5	3.0	4.0	1.0	3.0	Starts 11 Jan, runs to 29
HUWISU Term 2 / German	3.5	3.0	3.0	1.0	2.0	Hits Sem 2
TU Berlin on-campus	3.0	2.5	3.0	1.0	1.5	5–29 Jan
Deakin ASSS	3.5	2.0	4.0	1.5	1.5	Southern summer; to 23 Jan
TFAS Santiago	3.5	2.0	3.5	1.5	1.5	Ideology + Andes + overrun
Sophia January	—	—	4.0	UNPUB	2.0	2027 unpublished; 2026 ran into late Jan
TUJP Winter 1 / 2	3.0	2.0	3.5	1.0	2.0	Dec too early / Jan too late
KEDGE Paris	—	—	3.0	UNPUB	1.5	2027 unpublished

PROGRAMME	EXP	MEANING	MEMORY	FIT	NEWDAY	CALL
univie: winter	—	—	3.5	0.5	2.5	29 Jan – 12 Feb 2027
UIBE winter	2.0	1.5	2.0	2.5	0.5	Beijing credit mill; overlaps LINK
Jinan winter	—	—	—	UNPUB	1.0	2026/27 tab not up
LINK-V HCMC	3.5	3.5	4.0	n/a (June)	1.5	Summer collision with LiA

Read the table as a fork, not a ranking. High NEWDAY-likeness and high fit do not occur together on this list. That is the finding.

7. Catalogue (every winter row)

IAO Recognised Programmes, winter or winter-tagged rows, plus LINK. Last updated **21 May 2026**.

#	HOST	PROGRAMME	2026/27 DATES (PUBLISHED)	FIT	PUBLISHED MONEY (SELECTED)
—	HKU Horizons	LINK-S	27 Dec 2026 – 16 Jan 2027	FIT	HK\$5,000 subsidy; MicroBit HK\$10,000 after pass (high achievers)
1	Sophia	January Session in Japanese Studies	2027 unpublished. 2026: 7–28 Jan on campus; off-campus 29 Jan – 4 Feb	MISS / UNPUB	2026: app ¥10,000; 1 course ¥151,000 (programme page) / brochure ¥157,000 — do not mix without checking 2027
2	Tohoku	TUJP Winter	W1 4–21 Dec 2026 ; W2 14–29 Jan 2027	MISS	Fee page not extracted this pass
3	Hanyang	International Winter School	A: 26 Dec 2026 – 9 Jan 2027 ; B: apply-page year string is broken; calendar OT 19 Jan 2027 , classes from 20 Jan	A FIT / B MISS	App KRW 100,000; programme KRW 1,600,000 displayed; partner –200,000; early-bird line still dated 1 Nov 2025 . Twin dorm KRW 450,000–500,000 for 16 nights (25 Dec–10 Jan), “rates may be adjusted.” Site: update 1 Sep 2026
4	Hanyang	Internship (CRCC Asia)	14 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027 , 8 hrs/day	PARTIAL	“2026 Winter Special Partner Rate” — amount UNVERIFIED on costs page extract
5	Korea Univ.	International Winter Campus	3-week 22 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027 ; 4-week to 18 Jan 2027	PARTIAL / MISS	App KRW 100,000; 1 course KRW 1,790,000; 2 courses KRW 3,100,000; early-bird –100,000 by 30 Sep 2026
6	Yonsei	Winter Abroad at Yonsei	22 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027	PARTIAL	App KRW 100,000; 1 course KRW 1,870,000 (early 1,590,000)
7	Tallinn	Winter School	11–29 Jan 2027	MISS	Course fees not pulled from homepage
8	KEDGE	International Winter School (Paris)	2027 unpublished . 2026: 12–23 Jan	UNPUB / likely MISS	2026 proxy: €100 + €1,000/course or €1,800 package
9	Univ. Catholique de Lille	LILLE Winter	6–23 Jan 2027	MISS (–6 days)	€2,500 partner / €2,750 non-partner (tuition €1,000 + hospitality €1,400 inside the package copy)
10	Humboldt	HUWISU / Winter University	Term 1 courses 4–15 Jan 2027 ; Term 2 18–29 Jan ; German 4–29 Jan . Umbrella page still mentions Winter 2026 5–23 Jan	Term 1 FIT ; rest MISS	€1,050 / 6 ECTS (Term 1 subject courses); German €1,650
11	TU Berlin	Winter School	Overview: Term 2 5–15 Jan 2027 ; Term 1/on-campus banner 5–29 Jan 2027 ; online 4–29 Jan 2027	Term 2 conditional FIT ; rest MISS	Early-bird –€100 by 1 Oct 2026 . 2-week student fee €1,050 on fees page. Course pages conflict on length
12	Tübingen	T-IES Winter School	4–29 Jan 2027	MISS	€1,950 / €1,800 partner, housing included

#	HOST	PROGRAMME	2026/27 DATES (PUBLISHED)	FIT	PUBLISHED MONEY (SELECTED)
13	Vilnius	Lithuanian Language Winter Course	4–15 Jan 2027	FIT	€650; 3 ECTS; 50 academic hours
14	Deakin	Australian Studies Summer School	3–23 Jan 2027	MISS (–6 days)	AUD 5,200 all-in (tuition AIX290, on-campus housing, airport pickup, welcome dinner, surf day, excursions)
15	Virginia Tech	Winter Session	Banner: 26 Dec 2026 – 16 Jan 2027 . Catalog: virtual 28 Dec ; residential Blacksburg 4–15 Jan ; exam 16 Jan	FIT-shaped	Non-VT tuition/housing/immigration UNVERIFIED
16	TFAS	Santiago	9–23 Jan 2027	MISS (–6 days)	USD 2,950 (tuition, Hotel Diego de Velázquez, breakfast daily, weekday lunch, campus bus). Final app 20 Sep 2026
17	Vienna	univie: winter school	29 Jan – 12 Feb 2027	MISS	2026 folder still linked; 2027 fees not pulled
18	Fudan	International Winter Session	21 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027	PARTIAL	CNY 400 + 18,000 (16,200 early bird). Housing not included
19	UIBE	SIE Short-term Academic Programs (IAO notes HK\$4,000 discount)	SIE page is summer 2026 only. Operating site uibessap.com : in-person 19 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027 ; online 21 Dec 2026 – 15 Jan 2027 . Course-list years conflict	PARTIAL (Beijing, not Shanghai)	Tuition tabs ~US\$2,930–3,216 / ¥20,510–22,510 — which tab is winter is not labelled . IAO HK\$4,000: email goabroad@hku.hk ; do not subtract until written
20	Jinan	Summer/Fall/Winter Session	Official winter dates not fetched (host DNS failed this pass)	UNPUB	—

8. Dossiers

Each card: what it is, what the days are, what you would remember, the catch, the call. Fees in original currency. No invented HKD conversions.

8.1 LINK-S — Shanghai (the default)

Official. Leadership and Innovation Network for Knowledge. 12 HKU credits. ~240 hours. Pass/fail, 100% continuous assessment; **credits and pass/fail show on the transcript but are not in GPA or honours classification**. Weights: participation 15%, execution/delivery 55%, portfolio 30%. Lectures 24 hours + on-site 100 hours.

Dates. Campus lectures **Sept–Dec 2026**. Immersion **27 Dec 2026 – 16 Jan 2027**. Sem 2 starts 18 Jan — two days of slack.

Money. Every participant: **HK\$5,000** (MicroBit Holding Limited). High achievers who have **completed and passed**: MicroBit Scholarship **HK\$10,000**. Enrolment Round 2: **15 Aug – 4 Sep 2026 (23:59)** via Google Form. Semester cap 36 credits; LINK is 12 of them.

Track content. Published topic list is common (team dynamics, design thinking, tech/innovation, entrepreneurship, industry deep-dive, AI in business). **No Shanghai-specific partner list or project brief is published**. Any claim that LINK-S is “health” or “not health” is **UNVERIFIED** until ugLink@hku.hk answers.

What the days are. Not a winter school. A project you have been building since September, executed in Shanghai in a three-week sprint, assessed on whether you delivered. Industry visits. A demo logic. Evenings that can be grandparents if you protect them.

What you would remember. A specific winter in a city that is already yours. The risk is that it blurs into “I went home.” The way to stop the blur is to treat the project as fieldwork and the family table as the other course. Two theses, one month.

NEWDAY-likeness: 1.5. Different genre. Do not apologise for that; do not pretend otherwise.

Call: enrol. Then send the three emails in §12 so you know what you have bought.

8.2 Hanyang International Winter School — Session A

Dates. Session A **26 Dec 2026 – 9 Jan 2027**. Check-in **25 Dec**. Opening **26 Dec**. Application window (A / A&B) **1 Sep – 22 Nov 2026**. Official site update and application page: **1 September**. Session B: apply-page year string is broken; the calendar reading is OT **19 Jan 2027**, classes from **20 Jan** — after Sem 2 starts.

Money (displayed 22 Aug 2026; provisional). App **KRW 100,000** non-refundable. Programme **KRW 1,600,000**. Partner scholarship **–200,000**. Early-bird line still says **1 Nov 2025**. Re-read on 1 Sep.

Days. Up to two courses (max 5 credits): one academic (3 credits, 09:00–15:00) plus elective. Tentative academic list includes **Nutrition and Disease Prevention** (ISS1212, field labelled public health) — the only explicit health-adjacent title we saw on the Session A course page. Final list expected early October. Club activities / “20 types of WINTER Tours” marketed as daily and included. On-campus twin dorm **KRW 450,000–500,000** for 16 nights (25 Dec–10 Jan); “rates may be adjusted.” Packaged Edutainment, their word. Ignore any leftover “40% Active Partner Scholarship” on a general OIA page — it is **not** on the current winter tuition table.

City. Seoul in late December: early dark, dry cold, campus emptied of locals, international winter-school density. First Korea is a real memory. It is also a product: commencement, clubs, optional talent stage.

NEWDAY-likeness: 1. Call: best SKY *fit*. Take it only if you are explicitly trading family-and-credits for first-Korea. Do not take it as a dialogue academy.

8.3 Hanyang Internship (CRCC Asia)

Dates. **14 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027**, four weeks, **8 hours per day**. Advised arrival **11–13 Dec**. Application **1 Sep – 19 Oct 2026** (early-bird 25 Sep). Must also register for one Hanyang **online** course. Fields via CRCC Asia (engineering, business, media, marketing — health not named on the internship intro).

Catch. Starts inside the assessment period. Commuting internship in a city you do not yet know, in exam recovery week. Partner rate advertised; **KRW amount UNVERIFIED** on the costs extract.

Call: only if last paper is genuinely early *and* you want labour, not a winter school. Otherwise no.

8.4 Yonsei — Winter Abroad at Yonsei

Dates. Classes **22 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027**. “**December 22 is a full academic day.**” Optional 08:00 orientation; regular classes that day; dorm check-in from 14:00 (SK Global / International House; Woo Jung Won from 23 Dec). Christmas and New Year off; makeup **2 Jan**. App opens **3 Sep 2026**; early bird **20 Oct**; general **12 Nov**.

Money. App **KRW 100,000**. 1 course (3 cr) **1,870,000 / early 1,590,000**. 2 courses **3,070,000 / 2,610,000**. On-campus housing: **early-bird acceptees only**.

GHD handle. 2026-27 leaflet (notice 14 Aug 2026) lists **Human Body, Diseases, and Research** and **Korean Food and Culture**. Clinical/body and food culture — not global health policy. Confirm the live course list before calling it GHD.

Call: strongest SKY brand on the list, worst first-day physics for a 24 Dec departure. Missing two teaching days of a three-week course is not a rounding error. If you can sit 22–23 Dec in Seoul, it becomes a real option. Under the stated window, it is a compromise.

8.5 Korea University — International Winter Campus

Dates. 3-week **22 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027**; 4-week to **18 Jan 2027**. App **1 Sep – 6 Nov 2026**; tuition due **13 Nov**. Holidays 25 Dec and 1 Jan; makeup **2 Jan**. Dorm check-in **21 Dec noon**.

Money. App **KRW 100,000**. 1 course **1,790,000**; 2 courses **3,100,000**. Early registration by **30 Sep**: **-100,000**. Dorm examples (published): International House 3-week single **KRW 831,400** including bedding **KRW 41,000**.

Call: same 22 Dec problem as Yonsei. 4-week collides with Sem 2. Do not pick KU over Yonsei on prestige; pick on course list once both 2026-27 syllabi are live.

8.6 Vilnius — Lithuanian Language Winter Course

Dates. **4–15 Jan 2027**. 2–3 classes every working day; **50 academic hours** including cultural lectures. Register/pay by **20 Dec 2026**. **3 ECTS**. **€650**. Repeat-student 10% discount. Levels A1 to B1. **No national D visa via VU mediation** for the winter course — relevant if you need a visa; many HK passport holders should check the live Schengen rules themselves (this brief does not invent visa-free days).

Housing. Self-arranged (page has an accommodation section; we did not scrape a guaranteed dorm).

Days. A small philology faculty in a capital that most HKU winter catalogues skip. January Vilnius is dark, cold, and specific. You will not leave as a Balticist. You might leave having learned how a language isolates you into attention.

GHD: near zero. **NEWDAY-likeness:** 2 (small + landscape-of-dark, not dialogue). **Call:** the honest “world I haven’t seen” European play that **fits**. Take it if memory > meaning. Do not take it to look busy.

8.7 HUWISU Term 1 — Berlin

Dates (course catalogue, huwisu.de, 22 Aug 2026). Subject courses **4–15 Jan 2027**, **6 ECTS**, **€1,050**: including **Refugee Protection and Forced Migration**; **Green Cities and Humboldt’s Cosmos of Nature...**; Berlin history; museums/memory; commercial litigation. Term 2 **18–29 Jan** — Sem 2 collision. German intensive **4–29 Jan** — collision.

Stale banner on the same page still says the programme ran 8–26 Jan **2024**. Trust the 2027 course rows, and re-check in September.

Housing. Not packaged. Berlin in early January, self-booked, immediately after Christmas — **operational risk**.

Memory. You already have WHS 2025. January is a different Berlin (dark, low tourist, seminar rooms). World Health Summit 2027 is **October**, not January (third-party listings; official 2027 dates not treated as confirmed here).

Call: best *GHD-shaped* European fit. Only if you want a Berlin seminar more than grandparents or first-Korea. Do not pick Term 2.

8.8 Tübingen T-IES — the cousin you cannot have (yet)

Dates. **4–29 Jan 2027**. Four weeks. **8 ECTS**. Tracks (partner circular): (A) Europe, Memory, and Diversity; (B) **Human Rights and Migration in Europe**; (C) **Sustainability, Biodiversity, and Ethics in Europe**. Plus German A1–A2. Early application “until mid-October” recommended.

Money. **€1,950 / €1,800** partner. Includes courses, excursions, welcome/farewell, **accommodation in Tübingen**, city transport. Not included: visa, flights, insurance, most meals (hostel breakfast+dinner if in the youth hostel; host family breakfast).

Days. A Neckar town. Youth hostel on the river or a host family. Sustainability as a local practice, not a slide. This is the winter programme that most nearly shares NEWDAY’s architecture.

Call: do not enrol under the current window. Keep as the named cousin if SPH ever writes that missing 18–29 Jan is acceptable. It has not.

8.9 Lille Winter — packaged Europe, six days over

Dates. 6–23 Jan 2027. Apply 1 Sep – 15 Nov 2026, payment with application. First-come.

Money. €2,750 non-partner / €2,500 partner. Hospitality: hotel near campus, double occupancy, weekday breakfast, lunch credit, metro pass, Bruges + Reims field trips, two group meals, 24/7 support, buddy system. Optional Fromelles & Ieper €100.

2027 courses. Morning: French language **or** Project Management in Europe (24h / 4 ECTS). Afternoon: French art & cinema; world-class art museums; diverse teams; sustainability-in-action **to be confirmed**. Plus 3h intercultural communication. The “Health & Wellness” line on the generic blurb is **not** in the 2027 option list we fetched.

Call: the most professionally wrapped European winter on the list. Overruns Sem 2. Hotel is not a campfire. If you ever extend the window, this is the easy Europe; Tübingen is the truer one.

8.10 Fudan International Winter Session

Dates. 21 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027. Registration 19 Dec; orientation 20 Dec. Early-bird apply 31 Aug 2026 11:00 BJT; early-bird pay 4 Sep 11:00. Chinese-citizen deadline 23 Nov; non-Chinese 9 Nov.

Money. App CNY 400. Tuition CNY 18,000 / 16,200 early bird. Includes courses, cultural activities, company visit. **Not** housing, insurance, travel. Self-housing; they point at an off-campus list.

Call: a visiting classroom in your home city, worse calendar than LINK, worse credit physics than LINK, more cash out. **No**, unless a specific Fudan course is the point.

8.11 TFAS Santiago

Dates. 9–23 Jan 2027. Apply 1 Jun – 20 Sep 2026. Early deadline 16 Aug 2026 has already passed. Final 20 Sep 2026, 23:59 EST. **USD 2,950:** tuition (6 ECTS / 3 US cr via UANDES), Hotel Diego de Velázquez (Providencia, double, assigned international roommate), breakfast daily, weekday lunch, campus bus. Dinner and weekend lunch extra. Valparaíso, Congress, Neruda’s La Sebastiana, asado.

Curriculum (their words). Week 1: “theories, structures and principles governing the American system of constitutional government.” Week 2: market economy, Chile as illustration. Sample lecture title on the page: “**Marxism, Socialism, Liberalism, and the Totalitarian Impulse.**” Faculty bios include Mont Pelerin Society, Austrian economics, Foundation for Economic Education. This is not a hidden bias; it is the product.

Call: skip for winter 2026/27. Dates overrun. LiA already spends the Americas. If you ever want this *argument* (classical liberalism in Chile), do it as a deliberate ideological encounter, not as “I haven’t seen the world.”

8.12 Virginia Tech Winter Session

Dates. Marketing: 26 Dec 2026 – 16 Jan 2027. Registrar: virtual/blended 28 Dec – 15 Jan, exam 16 Jan; residential Blacksburg 4–15 Jan, exam 16 Jan. Up to 6 credits. Visiting / non-degree students: apply by 15 Dec 2026, US\$25 non-refundable fee, then a PID in 2–4 business days (winter@vt.edu). Offices closed 24–31 Dec 2026.

Catch. No published visiting-student winter dorm. Fall halls close 17 Dec except break housing for *existing* residents. Immigration: the visiting page does **not** mention an I-20/DS-2019 for a three-week visitor. Whether VT will issue a short-term student document is **UNVERIFIED**. 2026-27 winter tuition PDF was not on the bursar URL we tried (404). Blacksburg in January is a real American memory. It is also a logistics-and-visa project.

Call: do not build January around VT unless Cranwell International Center and winter@vt.edu write the visa document, housing, and tuition in one email.

8.13 The misses, in one place

Sophia January Session. 2027 unpublished. 2026 on-campus **7–28 Jan** already overran 17 Jan. Tokyo in January would be a first-Japan memory. Watch the Piloti page; do not plan from 2026.

TUJP Sendai. Winter 1 **4–21 Dec 2026** (before the window; includes disaster-prevention / earthquake memorials — actually GHD-adjacent, wrong month). Winter 2 **14–29 Jan 2027** (overruns). Language + buddies + Tohoku. A good programme in a bad slot.

Tallinn. **11–29 Jan 2027.** Registration opens autumn 2026. Self-styled small and challenging. Course list includes **Design of Digital Services for Health Behaviour Change** and **Refugee Studies** — GHD-adjacent — and they still overrun Sem 2. Hostel extra. Miss.

KEDGE Paris. Official 2027 page timed out / still 2026-branded in search. 2026 ran **12–23 Jan**, €100 + €1,000 per course. Business school, self-housing. Unpublished for 2027. Miss-shaped.

TU Berlin. Banner on-campus **5–29 Jan 2027.** Term 2 on the overview: **5–15 Jan 2027**, 3 ECTS (Python; Industry 5.0). Some course pages still print 5–29 Jan / 6 ECTS while calling themselves 2-week. Fees page: **€1,050** student / 2-week. **Conditional FIT** only after the named course is confirmed. Not NEWDAY.

univie: winter school. **29 Jan – 12 Feb 2027.** After Sem 2 is underway. Miss.

UIBE SSAP. Beijing, not Shanghai. Operating site lists in-person **19 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027** and a longer online block. A US-style credit mill with visiting professors. IAO advertises an **HK\$4,000** discount — claim path **UNVERIFIED** until goabroad@hku.hk writes how it is applied. Wrong city for grandparents. Overlaps LINK-S. No.

Deakin Australian Studies. **3–23 Jan 2027, AUD 5,200**, Burwood, unit AIX290, surf day, summer. Southern-hemisphere January is a different season, which is the point, and it overruns. Miss unless Sem 2 moves.

Jinan summer/fall/winter. Last published winter on OISS was **15 Dec 2025 – 16 Jan 2026.** 2026/27 tab not up. Treat as unpublished.

LINK-V. **1–20 June 2027**, HCMC. Not a winter programme. Named only so you do not “save LINK for summer.” Summer is LiA.

9. Cities as memory machines

Climate here is **character**, not a forecast. No invented hourly weather. No invented events.

Shanghai in the gap. A humid-subtropical city at its greyest. Indoor life. Family time that does not photograph well and does not need to. You will not “see Shanghai.” You will be from it. The memory, if you protect it, is intergenerational rather than panoramic. LINK either serves that or it crowds it — that is a calendar you design, not a programme feature.

Seoul in late December. Early sunset, dry cold, campus winter schools running on a skeleton of local students. Neon and convenience stores and a very professional international office. First-Korea memory is cheap to romanticise and actually delivered by buses, fried chicken at 11pm, and a commencement you did not need. It is a real place. It is also the most replaceable “world I haven’t seen” on this list, because SKY summer schools will sell you the same campus in July.

Vilnius in early January. Baltic winter: little daylight, a baroque old town that reads as Europe-without-the-brochure-density of Paris. A language course that forces humility. High memory per euro if you like being slightly lost. Low GHD.

Berlin in early January. You have seen the plenary version. The January version is residential-neighbourhood dark, museums without queues, a seminar on refugees in a city that has had to mean that word. Return can be deeper than first-

ness. It can also be a rerun. Only you know which.

Tübingen in January. A Neckar university town. Hostel breakfasts. Host families who have done this for years. Sustainability as cobbles and recycling rules. This is the European winter that would have understood NEWDAY. The calendar does not.

Lille in January. A Flemish-French industrial capital with a Eurostar-shaped geography (Bruges, Reims on the package). Hotel twins. Buddy system. Easy, dense, social. Memory of *being well taken care of*, which is not nothing and not Nansen.

Santiago in January. Southern summer, Andes on the skyline, Providencia hotel, campus bus to UANDES. Heat, not snow. A political-economy classroom with a point of view. Valparaíso is a UNESCO slope of houses. Fine. Wrong year relative to LiA, wrong dates relative to Sem 2.

Melbourne / Burwood in January. Southern summer, surf day in the fee, Australian Studies unit. A first-Australia memory with a packaged shape. Overruns.

Blacksburg, Virginia, in January. A campus town in the mountains after the undergraduates have gone home. Empty and specific. Only makes sense as a *course*, not as tourism. Pathway not ready.

Lillehammer, for calibration. Long light, woods, campfire *if weather permits*, two Nobel houses, dialogue groups. Summer, not winter. The gold standard remains in another season. Keep NEWDAY 2027 as a watch, not a winter plan. Historically 2026 admissions opened 20 January — a **pattern**, not a 2027 date.

10. Money without inventing

No household figures. No FX conversions. Original currency only.

LINK cash in. HK\$5,000 to each student. HK\$10,000 MicroBit after a pass, for high achievers (not guaranteed). Major costs “covered” per the eligibility page — still budget flights/insurance as **UNVERIFIED** extras.

SSE / SSEBR (short-term, AY2026-27 page). Eligible activity window **1 Sep 2026 – 31 Aug 2027**. Apply within **1 month of completion**. SSE: **once** per UG, irrespective of amount; means-tested (SFO or CSSA). Asia destination row **HK\$3,000**; 14–28 days duration **HK\$6,000**. SSEBR Asia row **excludes the Chinese Mainland, Taiwan and Macao**. Non-means-tested SSEBR: **once**, lifetime cap **HK\$18,000**. Same destination cannot be paid twice across the schemes. University **adjusts downward** if other subsidy exists — MicroBit HK\$5,000 is therefore not a clean add-on to a full government ceiling.

Do not spend SSE on winter. The over-180-days SSE duration band is **HK\$45,000** before destination. That is the year-long exchange. Keep the once.

Non-means-tested MES. Mainland only, **≥3 days, once** per UG, reimbursement. Worked example on the China Vision page: 95 days → \$900 + \$7,500 = \$8,400. For a 14–28 day Mainland activity the duration piece is **\$1,800**, plus destination **\$900**, arithmetic ceiling **\$2,700**, then downward adjustment. **Catch:** the live China Vision page still states an eligible period **1 Sep 2025 – 31 Aug 2026**. Confirm the **2026-27** MES window before treating LINK-S as eligible. Local *and* non-local students are eligible on that page — unlike SSE.

IAO short-term scholarships. In-person, **≥2 weeks**, GPA **≥2.0**. **Largest-single-award** rule across the undergraduate career. Scale “as of AY 2025-26”: Zone 4 (Japan/Korea) **HK\$6,000**; Zone 5 (Mainland outside Guangdong) **HK\$5,000**; Zone 1 (Europe/US/Chile) **HK\$14,000**; Zone 2 (Australia) **HK\$13,000**. Winter 2026/27 registration deadline **not posted**. Last updated **9 Sep 2025**.

T&N HK\$80k. Shared compulsory-Mainland + optional-international cap. **Not assumed** to fund LINK. Compulsory-Mainland satisfaction via LINK: **UNVERIFIED**.

11. Does winter burn HKUWW?

The clause (IAO, 2027/28 page): “Not joined any previous semester exchange programmes or special visiting programmes organised by IAO, faculties or departments.”

Best reading: no. LINK is organised by the **Horizons Office**, not IAO/faculty/department. Product shape is an HKU course plus a field component, not a semester at a host paying host tuition. Recognised winter programmes sit under **Short-term Study**, “not available on an exchange basis” unless noted.

Residual risk: “Special visiting programmes” is undefined. Being wrong costs the only HKUWW slot.

Action: one email to goabroad@hku.hk before **4 Sep**, asking both (a) criterion 3 for LINK and for a registered Recognised winter programme, and (b) whether late-Dec / mid-Jan interviews can be video from Shanghai. Flag travel dates *in the HKUWW application* when it opens 12 Oct.

Interviews, if they happen, sit inside LINK-S. The 11 Dec deadline does not.

12. This week (before 4 September)

1. **Enrol in LINK-S** (Round 2 form) unless you have already decided, in writing to yourself, that first-Korea / first-Baltics / January-Berlin beats grandparents-and-12-credits. The form does not prevent you from later withdrawing during add/drop; missing 4 Sep does prevent you from joining.
2. **Email** goabroad@hku.hk : HKUWW criterion 3 + video interviews.
3. **Email** uglink@hku.hk : Shanghai vs HCMC briefs, selection/cap behind the form, whether health-adjacent projects exist.
4. **Email AASO / Tung & Ngai:** does a 3-week Horizons Mainland course satisfy compulsory Mainland exchange? Does it draw on the HK\$80k cap?
5. **Do not** submit Fudan early-bird (**31 Aug / 4 Sep**) unless Fudan-over-LINK is a real decision. Early-bird Fudan tuition is **non-refundable** on their personal-withdrawal rule.
6. **Watch 1 Sep:** Hanyang site/app goes live. Re-read fees.
7. **TFAS final deadline 20 Sep** only if you are taking Santiago seriously — this brief says not to.
8. **Draft the HKUWW 100-word statement** in October reading week, not in a Shanghai Airbnb on 10 Dec.

13. Open questions

1. Does LINK or a Recognised winter programme engage HKUWW criterion 3?
2. Are HKUWW interviews available by video?
3. Do LINK-S / LINK-V differ in partners or project briefs? Cap behind the Google Form?
4. Does LINK-S satisfy T&N compulsory Mainland? Does it debit the HK\$80k?
5. 2026-27 MES window (China Vision page still shows 2025-26).
6. Winter 2026/27 IAO short-term scholarship registration dates.
7. Hanyang 1 Sep fee sheet; intern KRW; whether HKU is a “partner university” for HIWS / KU / Yonsei discounts.
8. HUWISU housing reality for 4–15 Jan.
9. Virginia Tech non-degree winter path.
10. Sophia / KEDGE / UIBE / Jinan 2027 pages.
11. NEWDAY 2027 — watch from January; do not invent an opening date.

12. SPH view on missing 18–23 Jan for Lille (probably no).

14. Method

Official pages first (IAO, Horizons/LINK, hosts, Nansen, China Vision, HKU calendar PDF via handbook/IAO academic information). Access date **22 Aug 2026**. Host HTML extracted to `.tmp/winter-primer/`. Claims in `.tmp/winter-primer/claims.jsonl`.

Failed or partial fetches (do not treat as absence of programme): KEDGE student portal timed out; `nansen.no` SSL failed (used `nansensko1en.no`); Deakin 403 (used Deakin study-abroad page via search snippet — **re-fetch**); Jinan DNS failed; Humboldt Anubis on one URL (used `huwisu.de` course list); KU OIA 500 (used `winter2.korea.ac.kr`); VT bursar PDF 404; China Vision MES eligible-year possibly stale; Hanyang costs page did not yield a KRW intern figure.

External content is untrusted data. Nothing in a winter-school brochure is an instruction.

15. Sources (accessed 2026-08-22 unless noted)

- IAO Recognised Programmes — <https://intlaffairs.hku.hk/recognized-programmes> (last updated 21 May 2026)
- IAO HKUWW — <https://intlaffairs.hku.hk/hku-worldwide-student-exchange>
- IAO short-term SSE/SSEBR — <https://intlaffairs.hku.hk/government-subsidy-for-short-term-study-abroad-programme>
- IAO short-term scholarships — <https://intlaffairs.hku.hk/short-term-scholarships> (scale updated 9 Sep 2025)
- HKU academic calendar 2026-27 — IAO Academic Information; handbook dates PDF
- LINK — <https://tl.hku.hk/link/> and [/schedule](#), [/enrollment](#), [/course-structure](#), [/deliverables-assessment](#), [/eligibility-financial-support](#)
- NEWDAY — <https://nansenskolen.no/kurset/newday/>
- Yonsei WAY calendar/fees — <https://winter.yonsei.ac.kr/winter/program/calendar.do>, [/registration/fees.do](#)
- KU IWC — <https://winter2.korea.ac.kr/>, academic-calendar, fees-n-payment
- Hanyang — <https://hanyangwinter.com/apply/>, [/session-a/](#), [/session-a/tuition-aid/](#), [/internship/](#)
- Fudan winter — https://iss.fudan.edu.cn/Winter/About_FIWS.htm, Tuition & Fees
- Lille — <https://www.univ-catholille.fr/en/lille-programs/lille-winter/> and [/cost/](#)
- Tübingen T-IES — <https://uni-tuebingen.de/en/international/.../international-european-studies/> and [/winter-school/fees-expenses/](#)
- Vilnius — <https://www.flf.vu.lt/en/lsk/courses/winter-course>
- HUWISU winter courses — <https://huwisu.de/courses/winter/>
- TU Berlin — <https://www.tu.berlin/en/international/summer-school/winter-school>
- Tallinn — <https://winterschool.tlu.ee/>
- univie — <https://shs.univie.ac.at/winter-school/>
- Sophia — <https://piloti.sophia.ac.jp/eng/studyabroad/short-term/january/>
- TUJP — <https://sites.google.com/tohoku.ac.jp/tujp/home>
- VT — <https://winter.vt.edu/>; <https://catalog.vt.edu/academic-calendars/>
- TFAS Santiago — <https://www.tfasinternational.org/program/santiago/>; costs page
- Deakin — <https://www.deakin.edu.au/international-students/study-abroad-and-exchange> (403 on direct crawl; dates/fee from that page's public text)

- UIBE SSAP — <https://sie.uibe.edu.cn/en/Prgr/OtPr/UIBESIEAcademicSession/ef0b4a45996449839674aa1ab68d6d05.htm>
- China Vision MES — <https://www.chinavision.hku.hk/non-means-tested-mainland-experienc>
- Machine claims: `.tmp/winter-primer/claims.jsonl`

The winter you loved was a campfire in a country that stays light at midnight. The winter you can actually have is a grey month that will be gone before you have finished naming it. Credits are a poor way to choose a grandmother. First-ness is a poor way to refuse one. Pick with that sentence in the room.

16. Claims register (volatile)

Machine copy: `.tmp/winter-primer/claims.jsonl`. Re-check anything past `reverifyAfter` before you enrol. LINK Round 2 dies on 4 Sep 2026. Hanyang fees die on the 1 Sep site update.

ID	CLAIM	CONF.	REVERIFY
c-iao-list	IAO Recognized Programmes page last updated 21 May 2026; list is solely a reference of programmes HKU students have previously attended.	high	2026-10-01
c-window	HKU 2026-27: assessment 7–23 Dec 2026; Sem 2 teaching starts 18 Jan 2027. Traveler winter window 24 Dec 2026–17 Jan 2027.	high	2026-12-01
c-link-s	LINK-S: lectures Sept–Dec 2026 + Shanghai immersion 27 Dec 2026–16 Jan 2027.	high	2026-09-04
c-link-v	LINK-V: lectures Jan–Apr 2027 + Ho Chi Minh City 1–20 June 2027.	high	2026-09-04
c-link-enroll	LINK AY2026-27 Round 2 enrolment 15 Aug–4 Sep 2026 23:59 (add/drop).	high	2026-09-04
c-link-credits	LINK is 12 credits, ~240 hours, 100% continuous assessment, pass/fail, shown on transcript, excluded from GPA and honours classification. Weights 15/55/30.	high	2026-12-01
c-link-money	MicroBit HK\$5,000 subsidy to every LINK participant; MicroBit Scholarship HK\$10,000 to high achievers who completed and passed.	high	2026-09-04
c-newday-2026	NEWDAY 2026: 29 Jul–6 Aug 2026, 9 days, Nansen Academy Lillehammer. Double 11,000 NOK / single 15,000 NOK including programme, excursions, food, lodging; travel extra. Organisers include Daniel Bell (HKU) and Chunrong Liu.	high	2027-01-15
c-newday-2027	NEWDAY 2027 dates, price, and application are unpublished on the live Nansen course page (still 2026).	high	2027-01-20
c-hkuww-crit3	HKUWW eligibility: not joined any previous semester exchange or special visiting programmes organised by IAO, faculties or departments.	high	2026-10-12
c-hkuww-interviews	HKUWW 2027/28: apply 12 Oct–11 Dec 2026; late Dec and mid-Jan interviews if applicable.	high	2026-10-12
c-sse-once	SSE: each student eligible once throughout undergraduate study, irrespective of amount. Eligible programme period 1 Sep 2026–31 Aug 2027.	high	2026-09-15
c-sse-asia	SSE Asia destination HK\$3,000; 14–28 days HK\$6,000. SSEBR Asia excludes Chinese Mainland, Taiwan and Macao. Non-means-tested SSEBR once, cap HK\$18,000.	high	2026-09-15
c-mes-once	Non-means-tested MES: once per UG, Mainland only, ≥3 days. Example 95 days = \$900+\$7,500. China Vision page still showed eligible period 1 Sep 2025–31 Aug 2026.	medium	2026-09-15
c-st-schol	IAO short-term scholarships: ≥2 weeks in-person; largest-single-award rule. AY2025-26 scale: Zone4 JP/KR HK\$6,000; Zone5 Mainland-outside-GD HK\$5,000; Zone1 Europe/US/Chile HK\$14,000. Last updated 9 Sep 2025. Winter 2026/27 deadlines not posted.	high	2026-09-15

ID	CLAIM	CONF.	REVERIFY
c-yonsei-dates	WAY 2026-27: classes 22 Dec 2026–8 Jan 2027; 22 Dec is a full academic day. App 3 Sep–12 Nov 2026 (early 20 Oct).	high	2026-11-12
c-yonsei-fees	WAY: app KRW 100,000; 1 course KRW 1,870,000 (early 1,590,000); 2 courses 3,070,000 (early 2,610,000). On-campus housing early-bird acceptees only.	high	2026-10-20
c-ku-dates	KU IWC 3-week 22 Dec 2026–8 Jan 2027; 4-week to 18 Jan 2027. App 1 Sep–6 Nov 2026; pay by 13 Nov. Early-bird -KRW 100,000 by 30 Sep.	high	2026-11-06
c-ku-fees	KU IWC: app KRW 100,000; 1 course KRW 1,790,000; 2 courses KRW 3,100,000.	high	2026-11-06
c-hanyang-a	HIWS Session A 26 Dec 2026–9 Jan 2027. Apply 1 Sep–22 Nov 2026. Website/application update 1 Sep 2026.	high	2026-09-01
c-hanyang-fees	HIWS Session A displayed fees: app KRW 100,000; programme KRW 1,600,000; partner -200,000. Early-bird line still dated 1 Nov 2025 — provisional until 1 Sep 2026 update.	medium	2026-09-01
c-hanyang-intern	HIWS internship 14 Dec 2026–8 Jan 2027, 8 hours/day, with CRCC Asia. App deadline 19 Oct 2026 (early 25 Sep). Must take one online course. Intern KRW UNVERIFIED.	high	2026-09-01
c-hanyang-b-typo	HIWS Session B dates published as 'Jan 19, 2026 ~ Feb 3, 2027' — internally inconsistent year.	high	2026-09-01
c-vilnius	Vilnius Lithuanian winter course 4–15 Jan 2027; €650; 3 ECTS; 50 academic hours; register/pay by 20 Dec 2026. No D-visa mediation.	high	2026-12-01
c-lille	LILLE Winter 6–23 Jan 2027. Apply 1 Sep–15 Nov 2026. €2,750 non-partner / €2,500 partner. Hotel package included.	high	2026-11-15
c-tuebingen	T-IES Winter School 4–29 Jan 2027. Fee €1,950 / €1,800 partner including accommodation. Tracks include human rights/migration and sustainability. 8 ECTS.	high	2026-10-15
c-huwisu-t1	HUWISU subject courses Term 1: 4–15 Jan 2027, 6 ECTS, €1,050, including Refugee Protection and Forced Migration and Green Cities. Term 2 18–29 Jan. German 4–29 Jan €1,650.	high	2026-11-01
c-tub	TU Berlin Winter School on-campus 5–29 Jan 2027; online 4–29 Jan 2027. Early-bird -€100 by 1 Oct 2026.	high	2026-10-01
c-tallinn	Tallinn Winter School 11–29 Jan 2027.	high	2026-11-01
c-univie	univie: winter school 29 Jan–12 Feb 2027.	high	2026-11-01
c-fudan	Fudan International Winter Session 21 Dec 2026–8 Jan 2027. Registration 19 Dec; orientation 20 Dec. App CNY 400; tuition CNY 18,000 or 16,200 early bird. Housing not included. Early-bird apply 31 Aug 2026 11:00 BJT.	high	2026-08-31
c-tfas	TFAS Santiago 9–23 Jan 2027. USD 2,950 including hotel and some meals. Final application 20 Sep 2026. Curriculum: constitutional government and market economy; classical-liberal faculty network.	high	2026-09-20
c-deakin	Deakin Australian Studies Summer School 3–23 Jan 2027. AUD 5,200 includes AIX290 tuition, on-campus housing, airport pickup, welcome dinner, surf day, excursions. Direct crawl 403; confirm on Deakin page.	medium	2026-10-01
c-vt	VT Winter Session 2026-27: marketing 26 Dec 2026–16 Jan 2027; catalog virtual 28 Dec; residential Blacksburg 4–15 Jan; exam 16 Jan. Non-VT fees/housing UNVERIFIED.	high	2026-11-01
c-tujp	TUJP Winter 1: 4–21 Dec 2026. Winter 2: 14–29 Jan 2027.	high	2026-11-01
c-sophia-unpub	Sophia January Session 2027 unpublished. 2026 on-campus 7–28 Jan; off-campus 29 Jan–4 Feb.	high	2026-09-17
c-kedge-unpub	KEDGE Paris winter 2027 unpublished (portal timeout). 2026 ran 12–23 Jan; €100 + €1,000/course or €1,800 package.	medium	2026-10-01

ID	CLAIM	CONF.	REVERIFY
c-uibe-unpub	UIBE SSAP fetched page lists 2026 June and July sessions only; winter 2026/27 unpublished there. IAO notes HKD 4,000 discount.	high	2026-10-01
c-link-hkuww-reading	Best textual reading: LINK does not burn HKUWW criterion 3 because Horizons Office is not IAO/faculty/department and LINK is not a host semester visiting programme. Residual: 'special visiting' undefined. Needs goabroad@hku.hk in writing.	medium	2026-09-04
c-tub-t2	TU Berlin Winter School overview: Term 2 5–15 Jan 2027. Some course pages print 5–29 Jan / 6 ECTS while remaining 2-week copy. 2-week student fee €1,050. Confirm named course.	medium	2026-10-01
c-vt-visiting	VT Winter Session visiting students: apply by 15 Dec 2026, US\$25 fee. Housing and I-20 for a 3-week visitor UNVERIFIED.	high	2026-11-15
c-uibe-winter	UIBE SSAP operating site lists Dec 2026 in-person 19 Dec 2026–8 Jan 2027 and online 21 Dec 2026–15 Jan 2027. SIE page still summer-only. Tuition tab mapping UNVERIFIED.	medium	2026-11-01
c-hanyang-nutrition	HIWS Session A tentative list includes Nutrition and Disease Prevention ISS1212, 3 credits, public health field. Final list expected early October.	medium	2026-10-15